

The Window on Rose Street

Book 9 of 10

*Every evening, the light comes on in the empty flat.
But no one should be there.*

CEFR Level A1 | Adult Graded Reader

Setting: A city apartment building on Rose Street. Nick's flat,

and the empty flat across the courtyard.

Genre: Quiet Mystery / Drama

Characters

- Nick - 44. Architect. Lives alone. Observant, quiet since his divorce.
- Clara - 38. The building manager. Practical and direct.
- Yara - 30. An artist using the empty flat without permission.

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Nick comes home from work at seven every evening. He puts his bag on the chair, makes tea, and stands at the window. From his window, he can see across the courtyard to the building on the other side. Flat 4B is always dark. It has been empty for three months. But tonight, there is a light on in flat 4B. Nick looks at it. He drinks his tea. He looks again. The light does not go out.

Flat 4B belonged to Mr. Petrov. He moved to his daughter's house in the north in January. Nick knows this because Clara, the building manager, told him. 'His daughter wanted him closer,' Clara said. That was three months ago. Since then, flat 4B has been dark. Until tonight.

Nick is not a nosy person. He has lived here six years. He knows his neighbours. But he does not knock on doors or ask questions. Tonight, he watches the window. He can see a shape inside. Someone is moving. Then - a shadow near the window. Then the curtains close. Nick finishes his tea.

The next morning, Nick goes to Clara's office on the ground floor. 'Flat 4B. Is someone moving

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Nick watches the mysterious light across Rose Street.

in?' Clara looks up. 'No. It is still empty. Mr. Petrov's daughter is trying to sell it.' 'There was a light on last night,' Nick says. Clara puts her pen down. 'A light?' 'At seven o'clock. For about an hour.' Clara writes in her notebook. 'I will check,' she says.

That evening the light comes on again. Seven fifteen. Same window. The curtains are already closed. But a soft yellow line shows under them. Nick photographs the window and sends it to Clara: 'Tonight again. 7:15.' Clara replies: 'I will go tomorrow morning. Key is in the office.'

Nick does not wait for Clara. At eight o'clock, he goes to the other building and rings the bell for flat 4B. Nothing. He rings again. The door intercom clicks. A voice - female, young. 'Yes?' 'I am your neighbour. I live across the courtyard. I can see your window from mine.' A long pause. Then: 'I am sorry. I will stop.'

Nick says: 'You do not have to stop. I was just curious. Are you all right?' Another pause. Then the door buzzes open. Nick goes upstairs and knocks. The woman who opens the door is young - about thirty. She has paint on her hands and on her jacket. She looks at him. 'I am not supposed to

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Nick discovers Yara's improvised art studio.

be here,' she says immediately.

The flat is not empty. There is a canvas on the floor, tins of paint on a table, drawings clipped to the wall. Nick looks around. 'You are an artist.' 'Yes. My name is Yara. I share a flat with three other people. I have no studio.' 'I know Mr. Petrov's daughter. She said I could use the flat - but not officially.' Nick looks at the paintings. They are very good.

Nick looks at the paintings. Twelve of them - the city, streets, windows, reflections in puddles, people at bus stops. Quiet, careful, beautiful. 'I already sent a message to Clara,' Nick says. He feels bad. Yara goes still. 'Clara is the building manager,' Nick says. 'I am sorry. I did not know someone was supposed to be here.' Yara nods. 'It is all right. I should not have been here officially.' She starts to gather her things.

Nick goes home and calls Clara immediately. 'I went to 4B. There is a woman. An artist. She has informal permission from Mr. Petrov's daughter. She is not damaging anything. She is painting.' Clara is quiet. 'The paintings are very good,' Nick adds. 'I need to speak to Mr. Petrov's daughter,' Clara says. 'Before you do - can you wait one day?

Let me think.' Clara waits. 'One day,' she says.

Nick is an architect. His studio has a large empty meeting room - they use it twice a year. He thinks about Yara. The paintings. The city. The next morning, he calls his studio manager. 'The meeting room. Can someone use it as a studio in the evenings and weekends? No cost.' 'Who?' 'An artist. I know her work. It is serious.' 'I will ask the partners,' the manager says.

The partners say yes. Nick goes back to flat 4B that evening. Yara opens the door. She is still there - she has not packed everything. Nick tells her about the meeting room. Yara looks at him. 'Why are you doing this?' 'I am an architect. I know what it is like to need a space. And your work-' He stops. He is not good at compliments. 'Your work is worth having a space,' he says.

Yara moves into the meeting room that Friday. Nick helps her carry the canvases. It is not comfortable - they barely know each other. But Yara says: 'You are good at carrying things for an architect.' Nick laughs. It is the first time he has laughed in several weeks. 'You are good at making people uncomfortable and then making them laugh,' he says. 'Is that a compliment?' 'Yes,' Nick

says. 'I think so.'

Three months later, Yara has twelve new paintings. The studio manager looks at them. 'These should be in an exhibition.' Yara looks at Nick. Nick looks at the paintings - the city, many windows, some with light, some dark. One painting shows a man at a window, looking across a courtyard. Nick looks at this one for a long time. 'That is my window,' he says. Yara smiles. 'Yes,' she says.

Nick looks at the painting. The man at the window is small - just a shape. But it is him. Standing with his tea. Looking across the courtyard. 'When did you paint this?' 'In the second week. When I still had the flat. I could see your window too.' Nick is quiet. 'I hope that is all right,' Yara says. 'Yes. It is strange. But all right.' 'Strange is usually interesting,' Yara says.

The studio has a small exhibition at a local gallery. Yara's twelve paintings are on the walls. Nick comes at seven. The room is full - friends, colleagues, people from the building. Clara is there. She looks at the paintings. 'I am glad I gave you one day,' she says to Nick. 'So am I,' he says. He looks at the painting of his window for a long

time.

After the exhibition, Nick and Yara walk to the canal. It is cold. 'What will you paint next?' 'I want to paint the sea. I have never been to the coast.' 'Seriously?' 'I grew up inland. Far from any sea.' Nick thinks about his small house in Cornwall. He goes there every August. He does not say anything yet.

In April, Nick says: 'I have a small house in Cornwall. In August. If you want to paint the sea - you can have the spare room.' Yara looks at him. 'For painting?' 'Yes. And walking. And eating. Normal things.' 'Are you inviting me on a holiday?' 'I am inviting you to paint the sea. The rest is up to you.' Yara is quiet. 'All right. Yes.'

In August, flat 4B is still empty. Mr. Petrov's daughter has not sold it. Nick does not stand at his window with his tea as much now. He is busier. But sometimes in the evening, he goes to the window. Flat 4B is dark and empty. He does not feel sad. He just thinks: the light was there once. And look what it started.

Nick comes home from work. He puts his bag on the chair. He makes tea. He goes to the

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Nick and Yara connect through art and conversation.

window. Rose Street is quiet. Flat 4B is dark. But on Nick's wall, there is a framed print of one of Yara's paintings - a window, light, a man standing with his tea. Nick looks at the painting. He looks at himself in it. He takes a sip of his tea. He is not alone anymore. Even when he is alone.

Story Vocabulary

The words below are collected from the story. They are given together so the reading pages stay like a real story book.

1. courtyard	avlu	2. empty	boş
3. light on	ışık açık	4. go out	sönmek
5. always dark	her zaman karanlık	6. belonged to	... aitti
7. building manager	bina yöneticisi	8. closer	daha yakın
9. since then	o zamandan beri	10. until tonight	bu geceye kadar
11. nosy	meraklı, burnunu sokan	12. shape	şekil
13. shadow	gölge	14. curtains	perdeler
15. ground floor	zemin kat	16. moving in	taşınmak
17. still empty	hâlâ boş	18. trying to sell	satmaya çalışıyor
19. check	kontrol etmek	20. already closed	zaten kapalı
21. soft yellow line	yumuşak sarı çizgi	22. photographs	fotoğraflıyor
23. thin	ince	24. rings the bell	zili çalar
25. intercom	interkom	26. clicks	tıklar
27. neighbour	komşu	28. pause	duraklama
29. curious	meraklı	30. buzzes open	elektrikle açılır
31. paint on her hands	ellerinde boya	32. not supposed to be	burada olmaması gerekiyor

33. canvas	tuval	34. clipped to	tutturulmuş
35. share a flat	ev arkadaşlığı	36. officially	resmi olarak
37. reflections	yansımalar	38. puddles	su birikintileri
39. bus stops	otobüs durakları	40. goes still	hareketsiz kalır
41. gather her things	eşyalarını toplamak	42. informal permission	gayri resmi izin
43. damaging	zarar veriyor	44. before you do	yapmadan önce
45. one day	bir gün	46. meeting room	toplantı odası
47. twice a year	yılda iki kez	48. no cost	ücretsiz
49. partners	ortaklar	50. packed everything	her şeyi topladı
51. worth having	... ye sahip olmaya değer	52. need a space	bir alana ihtiyaç duymak
53. carry	taşımak	54. barely	zar zor
55. laughs	güler	56. several weeks	birkaç hafta
57. exhibition	sergi	58. many windows	birçok pencere
59. looking across	karşıya bakıyor	60. That is my window	Bu benim pencerem
61. just a shape	sadece bir şekil	62. second week	ikinci hafta
63. strange	tuhaf	64. usually	genellikle
65. local gallery	yerel galeri	66. colleagues	meslektaşlar

67. glad	memnun	68. So am I	Ben de öyleyim
69. canal	kanal	70. coast	kıyı
71. seriously	ciddi misin	72. grew up inland	iç kesimlerde büyüdü
73. yet	henüz	74. spare room	misafir odası
75. normal things	normal şeyler	76. inviting	davet etmek
77. the rest is up to you	gerisi sana kalmış	78. sold	sattı
79. busier	daha meşgul	80. dark and empty	karanlık ve boş
81. once	bir zamanlar	82. look what it started	bak neye yol açtı
83. framed print	çerçeveli baskı	84. takes a sip	bir yudum içer
85. not alone anymore	artık yalnız değil	86. even when	... olduğunda bile

After-Reading Activities

1. Vocabulary Practice - Match the Words

Match each word with the correct meaning.

1. courtyard

A. avlu

2. curtains

B. yansıma

3. reflection

C. perdeler

4. puddles

D. su birikintileri

5. exhibition

E. sergi

6. inland

F. iç kesimlerde

7. spare room

G. misafir odası

8. nosy

H. meraklı, burnunu sokan

2. Fill in the Blanks

Choose the correct word from the box and write it in the blank.

light - empty - paintings - alone - permission - sea

1. Flat 4B has been _____ for three months.

2. Nick sees a _____ on in flat 4B in the evening.

3. Yara has informal _____ to use the flat.

4. Yara paints the city - especially streets and windows.

5. At the end, Nick is not _____ anymore.

6. Nick invites Yara to Cornwall to paint the _____.

3. Comprehension Questions

True or False? Write T or F.

1. Mr. Petrov died - that is why the flat is empty. ____
2. Nick is a doctor. ____
3. Clara is the building manager. ____
4. Yara is using the flat with official permission. ____
5. Nick offers Yara a room in his studio. ____
6. Yara paints Nick's window in her paintings. ____

Short Answer Questions

7. Why is flat 4B empty?
8. What does Nick see in the flat when Yara opens the door?
9. What does Nick do to help Yara after he tells Clara?
10. What do the paintings show?
11. How does Nick feel when he laughs for the first time in weeks?
12. What does Yara say she wants to paint next?
13. What does Nick invite Yara to do in August?
14. What does Nick put on his wall?
15. What does the last line mean?

Answer Key

(Alıştırmaları yaptıktan sonra bakınız.)

Match: 1-A 2-C 3-B 4-D 5-E 6-F 7-G 8-H

Fill in the Blanks: 1. empty 2. light 3. permission 4. windows 5. alone 6. sea

True / False: 1. F 2. F 3. T 4. F 5. T 6. T

7. Mr. Petrov moved to his daughter's house in the north.

8. Canvases, tins of paint, drawings on the wall, and lamps - an artist's studio.

9. He finds her a free space at his architecture studio.

10. The city - streets, windows, reflections in puddles, people at bus stops.

11. Something is changing in him - first real moment of connection in weeks.

12. She wants to paint the sea - she has never been to the coast.

13. He invites her to stay in the spare room at his house in Cornwall.

14. A framed print of one of Yara's paintings - the one showing his window.

15. He has company in his life, so even when physically alone, he does not feel alone.